CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

PAINTING COMPANY OWNER IN THE AI ERA

Spray robots paint warehouses. Homeowners still hire people who tape, prep and don't drip on the piano.

★ TL;DR — Owners around ~$75K on the site's scale, startable in 1–6 months with no license in most places for residential repaint work. The catch: prep is most of the quality and none of what clients think they're paying for. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

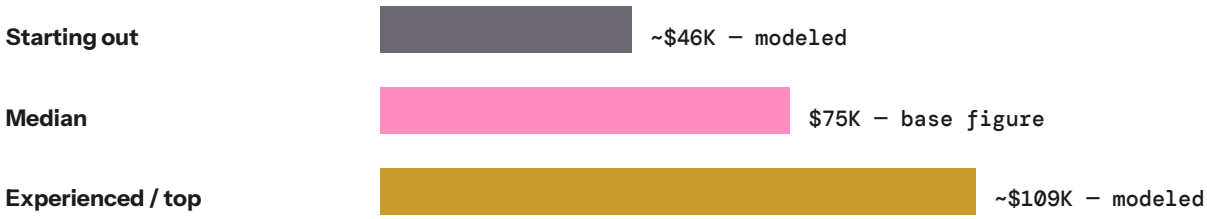
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Repaints are visual, fast-turning and referral-driven — an ideal owner trade.
- Exteriors are seasonal in cold states; interiors smooth out the winter.
- Estimating software measures walls; straight lines and prep discipline still win the reviews.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Painting Company Owner is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A PAINTING COMPANY OWNER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Estimate jobs: measure, assess prep, write the quote

- ✓ Mask, patch, sand, caulk and prime
- ✓ Paint interiors, exteriors and cabinets
- ✓ Walk the finished job with the client and punch-list the details

Think: makeup artistry at building scale — prep is everything, finish is the photo.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Color visualizers, measuring apps and estimating software price jobs faster. Marketing and follow-up run on automation.	Surface prep, cutting clean lines, and spotting the failing paint a photo hides — craft judgment on a ladder, not in a cloud.

⚠ **Lowball bidding wars are constant; your profit lives in estimating accuracy, not in the painting itself.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Visible transformations and same-week results ✓ Repeat clients: houses need paint on a cycle ✓ Crews scale without heavy equipment costs	✗ Ladders, fumes and sun are the office ✗ Weather moves exterior schedules weekly ✗ Cabinet and detail work punishes rushed prep

Good fit? Steady-handed, patient with prep, and an honest estimator.
Bad fit? You rush detail work or hate heights and ladders.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — PAINT FOR A CREW FIRST	DOOR B — START WITH INTERIORS
A season on a professional crew teaches production pace, prep standards and estimating reality. You'll see which jobs make money before risking your own bids.	Register, insure, and launch with interior repaints and cabinets — no scaffolding empire needed, year-round work, and every finished room is an ad in the client's group chat.

Smart move: Specialize in kitchen cabinets: small footprint, premium prices, and a portfolio that sells itself.
Where you land after: Solo painter → crew leader with 2–3 painters → you estimate, sell and manage multiple crews.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN PRODUCTION	SET UP	ESTIMATE LIKE	WIN THE	BUILD A	ADD THE

STEP 1 — Learn production painting

FREE · WEEKS

- Study the prep order: clean, patch, sand, caulk, prime, paint.
- Practice spraying and cutting-in on your own walls until lines are clean.

STEP 2 — Set up and insure

WEEKS

- Register the business, get liability insurance, build a simple quote template.
- Decide your lanes — interiors, exteriors, cabinets — and price each separately.

STEP 3 — Estimate like an owner

MONTHS 1-2

- Measure everything; write prep hours into every bid, visibly.
- Track actual hours per job to fix your estimating within weeks.

STEP 4 — Win the first jobs

MARKETING

- Realtors, property managers and past clients of any trade you know.
- Room-by-room pricing posts well in neighborhood groups.

STEP 5 — Build a crew

FIRST SEASON

- Hire for neatness and reliability; painting skill can be trained.
- Daily walkthroughs: your finish standard is the brand.

STEP 6 — Add the premium lane

MONTH 6+

- Cabinets and fine finishes raise the average ticket size.
- Maintenance agreements for landlords and HOAs smooth the seasons.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: write your prep checklist and a per-room price model.
- □ Days 1–30: business live; first interior jobs from your network.
- □ Days 31–60: tracking hours against estimates; reviews after every job.
- □ Days 61–90: first crew help on bigger jobs; cabinet package launched.
- □ Day 90: steady repaint work — profit now depends on estimating discipline.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ PREP IS THE PRODUCT. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.